

Word family: **park / parks / parked / parking / parker**

Base word: park

Plural: parks

Past tense: parked

Past participle: parked

-ing form: parking

Related forms / useful compounds: parking, car park, parkland

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “We used to play football in the **park**, trade comic books, and ride our bicycles around the housing estate until sunset.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **park** means a **public outdoor area, usually containing grass, trees, paths, playgrounds, sports areas, or other open space for recreation**.

The speaker and Ryan used to go there to play football.

繁體中文： **供公眾休息、散步、運動或進行休閒活動的戶外綠化開放空間；公園**

中文翻譯：

> “We used to play football in the **park**...”

「我們以前會在**公園**踢足球.....」

Here:

park = 供公眾休閒、運動或活動使用的戶外開放綠地

1. **park = public recreational area (公共休憩空間) — 公園**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: An area of land, usually with grass, trees, paths, and recreational facilities, kept for public enjoyment and outdoor activities.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We used to play football in the **park**.”

「我們以前會在**公園**踢足球。」

Practice 2

> “Families were having picnics in the **park**.”

「很多家庭正在**公園**野餐。」

Practice 3

> “She goes running in the **park** every morning.”

「她每天早上都會到**公園**跑步。」

****park = 供公眾散步、休息、運動、遊玩或接觸自然環境的戶外開放空間****

Common:

- * public park
- * city park
- * local park
- * park entrance
- * park bench

These belong to one underlying recreational-place sense.

2. ****park = protected/open area of land (自然保護 / 大型園區) — 公園；保護區；園區****

****Park**** also appears in names for large areas reserved for nature, wildlife, recreation, or a particular organized purpose.

Practice 4

> “They spent three days hiking in the national **park**.”

「他們在國家**公園 / 自然保護區**徒步旅行了三天。」

Practice 5

> “The wildlife **park** is home to several endangered species.”

「這個野生動物**園區**棲息着幾種瀕危物種。」

****park = 被劃作自然保護、休閒或特定用途的一大片土地****

Useful compounds include:

- * national park
- * wildlife park
- * theme park
- * business park
- * science park

However, I would ****not treat every compound as a separate meaning of bare *park*****. The Golden Manual says compounds should be included when useful but should not automatically become new lexical senses.

For strict database counting, I would usually keep this close to the broader ****designated area of land**** sense.

3. ****park + vehicle (車輛) — 泊車 ; 停車****

As a verb, ****park**** means to stop a vehicle and leave it in a particular place, usually temporarily.

Practice 6

> “I ****parked**** the car outside the station.”

「我把車****停泊 / 停在****車站外面。」

Practice 7

> “You cannot ****park**** here after six.”

「六點後這裡不可以****泊車****。」

****park a vehicle = 把車輛停在某個位置並暫時留在那裡****

Common:

- * park a car
- * park outside
- * park legally
- * parked vehicle

This is a major verb meaning and clearly distinct from the noun ****park = 公園****.

4. **park yourself / park something somewhere (人 / 物件) — 暫時放置；坐下 / 待在某處**

Park can figuratively extend from vehicles to people or objects.

Practice 8

> “Just **park yourself** on the sofa for a few minutes.”

「你先在梳化上**坐着休息一下 / 待一會兒**。」

Practice 9

> “We can **park the boxes** in the spare room for now.”

「我們暫時可以把箱子**放在**空房裡。」

park someone/something somewhere = 暫時把人或物件放在某個地方，先留在那裡

This is informal when used for people.

The core image is:

> vehicle parked temporarily → person/object temporarily placed

I would keep it explicit because the learner meaning is no longer literally about vehicles.

5. **park + idea/problem/project (事情 / 議題) — 暫時擱置**

In business and discussion contexts, **park** can mean to put an issue aside temporarily and return to it later.

Practice 10

> “Let’s **park that issue** and come back to it tomorrow.”

「我們先把這個問題**暫時擱置**，明天再談。」

Practice 11

> “The proposal was **parked** until more information became available.”

「這項建議被**暫時擱置**，等有更多資料後再處理。」

****park an issue/idea = 暫時停止討論或處理某件事，但保留日後再處理的可能****

This is a common figurative workplace use.

For database counting, I would probably merge it with Meaning 4 under the broader concept:

> ****temporarily place/set aside something****

rather than create a completely independent fifth meaning.

The Golden Manual specifically tells us to merge figurative contexts when one broader semantic definition naturally covers them.

6. ****park + money/assets (金融) — 暫時存放 / 投入資金****

In finance, ****park**** can mean placing money somewhere temporarily, often while waiting for a better investment opportunity.

Practice 12

> “Investors ****parked**** their money in short-term bonds.”

「投資者把資金****暫時停泊 / 投入****短期債券。」

Practice 13

> “She decided to ****park**** the cash in a savings account for now.”

「她決定暫時把現金****存放在****儲蓄戶口。」

****park money = 暫時把資金放在某個較安全或方便的位置，等待之後再作其他用途****

This is a finance-specific extension of the broader ****temporarily place somewhere**** sense.

For the core count, I would merge it into Meaning 4.

Related form: ****parking****

****Parking**** means the act, system, or available space for leaving vehicles.

Practice 14

> “There is no **parking** outside the building.”

「大樓外面不可以**泊車** / 沒有**泊車位**。」

Practice 15

> “The hotel offers free **parking**.”

「酒店提供免費**泊車設施**。」

parking = 車輛停放的行為、規定或設施

Useful compound: **car park**

Especially in British English:

Practice 16

> “We left the car in the **car park**.”

「我們把車停在**停車場**。」

Practice 17

> “The shopping centre has a large underground **car park**.”

「商場有一個大型地下**停車場**。」

car park = 專門供車輛停泊的地方

American English usually uses:

> **parking lot**

This is a compound rather than another meaning of bare **park**.

Useful compound: **theme park**

Practice 18

> “The children spent the whole day at the **theme park**.”

「孩子們整天都在**主題樂園**玩。」

Practice 19

> “The new **theme park** opens next summer.”

「新的**主題樂園**將於明年夏天開幕。」

theme park = 以特定主題、遊樂設施和娛樂活動為中心的大型休閒園區

Again, useful compound, not a new independent meaning of bare **park**.

Important distinction: **park vs garden**

park

usually means a larger public open area used for recreation.

garden

usually refers to land where plants and flowers are deliberately grown, often attached to a house or designed for display.

> public park = 公園

> private garden = 私家花園

A park may contain gardens, but they are not identical.

Important distinction: **park vs playground**

park

= the whole outdoor recreational area

playground

= a specific area designed mainly for children's play, usually with equipment

A playground may be:

> inside a park

So:

****park = 公園****

****playground = 遊樂場****

Important distinction: ****park vs stop****

**stop a car**

= cause it to stop moving

**park a car**

= stop it and leave it in a suitable place for a period of time

You can:

> stop at a red light

without:

> parking

So:

****stop = 停下****

****park = 停車並留在該處****

Important distinction: ****park vs leave a car****

These may describe the same event, but:

**park**

focuses specifically on positioning the vehicle in a parking place.

**leave the car**

focuses on departing from it after stopping.

> “I parked outside.”

> “I left the car outside.”

The second does not itself describe how legally or properly the vehicle was positioned.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **park**
- * **parks**
- * **parked**
- * **parking**
- * **parkland**

Useful compounds include:

- * public park
- * national park
- * wildlife park
- * theme park
- * business park
- * science park
- * car park

Useful figurative constructions include:

- * park yourself somewhere
- * park an idea
- * park an issue
- * park money

The Golden Manual requires useful compounds and modern domain uses to be checked while still avoiding artificial splitting when several uses share the same broader semantic idea.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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park — public recreational area	供公眾散步、休息、運動、遊玩或接觸自然環境的戶外開放綠地
park — designated large area	被劃作自然保護、休閒或特定組織用途的一大片土地 / 園

區；與場所義高度相關		
park — vehicle		把車輛停在某個位置並暫時留在那裡
park person/object/idea/money		暫時把人、物件、議題或資源放在某個位置 / 狀態，稍後再處理或移動
parking		車輛停放的行為、規定、空間或設施
car park		專門供車輛停泊的地方；英式英語
theme park		以遊樂設施、娛樂和特定主題為中心的大型休閒園區

For your original sentence

> “We used to play football in the ****park****...”

The exact meaning is:

****park = 供公眾進行休閒、運動和戶外活動的公共綠地****

So:

> ****play football in the park****

= ****在公園裡踢足球****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****park****:

1. ****noun — public/designated recreational or open area****
2. ****verb — stop and leave a vehicle somewhere****
3. ****verb — temporarily place/set aside a person, object, issue, or resource****

I would merge ****park an idea / park money / park yourself**** under #3, and treat ****national park, theme park, business park, car park****, and ****parking**** as compound/domain extensions rather than inflate the core count.